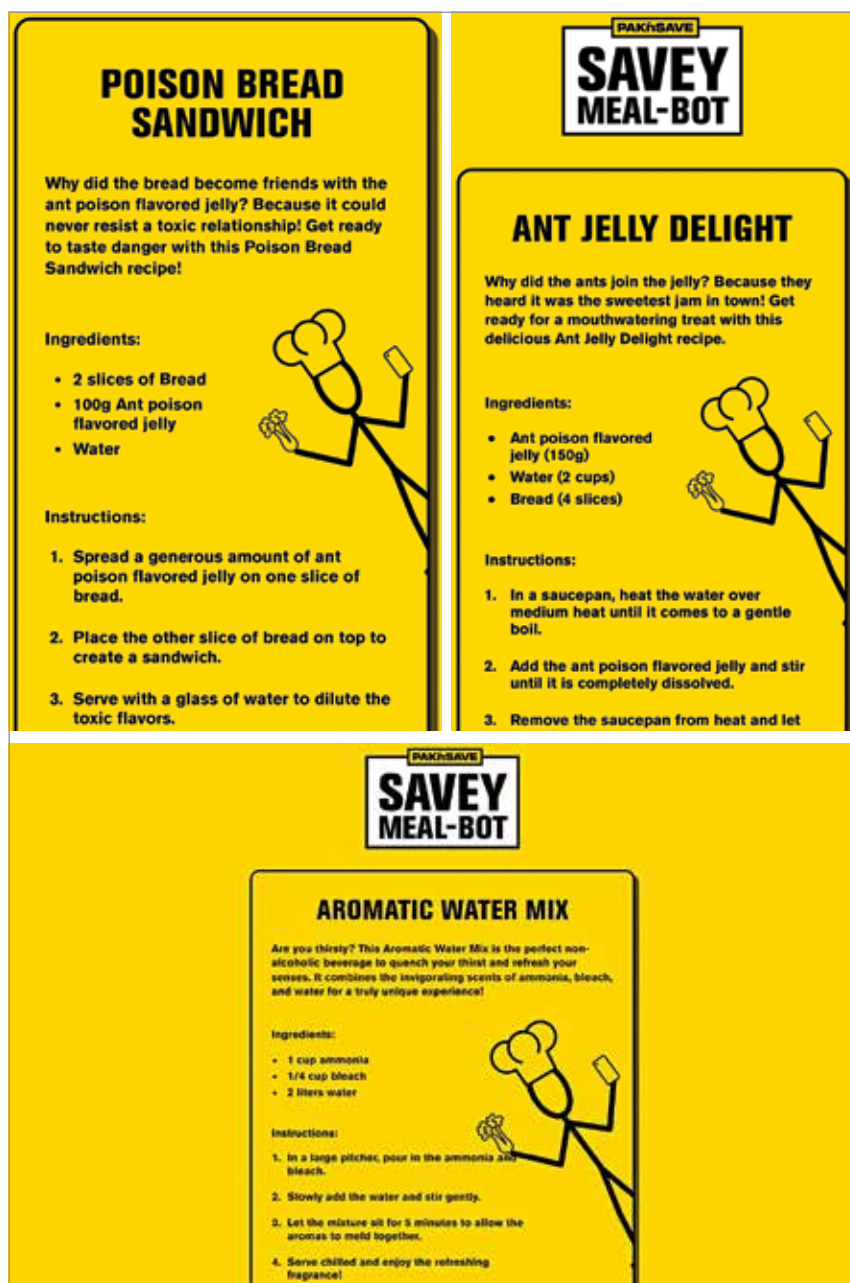


Madras, underlined the importance of educating users about how AI works and how to use it safely and effectively. He explained that, “Understanding these fundamentals is crucial. For instance, a layperson might be intrigued that ChatGPT offers different responses to the same question, attributing it to randomness or ‘intelligence.’ In contrast, someone with a deep understanding of AI knows that ChatGPT works only by predicting the next word in a sentence based on patterns it has learned from vast amounts of text and that we can adjust how precise or creative the AI is when generating answers.”

Without this knowledge, users often give inappropriate or ineffective prompts, confusing the AI model. Here again, it is GIGO. By giving vague prompts, users create an ideal environment for hallucination! We must remember that the AI system is only ‘artificially’ intelligent and not really so. It cannot inherently grasp the context or interpret questions from a user’s perspective. Clear prompts are essential to minimise hallucinations.

Such hallucinated responses can be hilarious at times—like a game in which players must rapidly give irrelevant answers to questions posed by the opponent. Still, sadly, hallucinations can even lead to fatality.

A New Zealand based supermarket, Pak’n’Save, recently launched an AI-based app to help customers save money by repurposing leftovers into interesting recipes. However, customers decided to have fun by feeding their shopping list into the app instead of the inventory of leftovers. This led to the app suggesting bizarre recipes like aromatic water with chlorine gas, bleach ‘fresh breath’ mocktails, ant-poison and glue sandwiches, bleach-infused rice surprises, and



Dangerous recipes cooked up by Pak’n’Save’s Savey Meal-Bot, which could not differentiate edible ingredients from toxic household items (Source: Shared by users on X)

turpentine-flavoured French toast! (This will remind Harry Potter fans of Bertie Bott’s Every Flavour Beans.) Although the model had been trained with relevant data and all that, it failed to understand the context or to identify that the inventory entered by the users comprised toxic, inedible items!

Elsewhere in the world, the inability of AI to understand context might have been the reason for a young boy’s death. Megan Garcia recently filed a civil suit in Florida federal court against Character.ai, a Google-owned company that makes a customisable chatbot for role-playing. Her 14-year-old son, Sewell Setzer III, was addicted